# 👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · Ag Science 1 · U.S. Food & Farm Facts (Level 3)

Level 3 = resource-room students who can work close to the gen ed lesson. Same topics and order as Mr. Torretta's class; more reading and writing than Level 2.

## 1. How the pieces line up

| Class lesson | Level 3 piece |
|---|---|
| US Food and Farm Facts Notes + Quiz | Reading parts 1-3; notes sections A and B; quick check |
| Food and Facts presentation | Notes section B (food dollar math) |
| The Future of Farming; Biggest Little Farm | Reading part 4; notes section C |
| Agriculture Literacy Poster | Reading part 5; myth/fact planning item |

## 2. Supports built in

- Reading and notes each have a web copy with a 🔊 Read aloud button (highlights as it reads)
- Key-word box at the top of the notes; word problems have a worked example first
- Less filled in than Level 2: short answers, tables, a drawing
- No slide decks: students follow Mr. Torretta's slides with the Level 3 notes

## 3. Files

- Reading (+ 🔊 web copy)
- Guided notes + key (+ 🔊 web copy)
- Quick check + key
- Unit game: 10 questions

## 4. What to grade

- Guided notes stand in for the matching class notes or worksheet (same points when complete)
- Quick check: score it, then scale to the class quiz points
- Reading check questions: completion points
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

## 5. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Class content: Mr. Torretta.

# 🚜 U.S. Food & Farm Facts: Guided Notes

Ag Science 1 · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with US Food and Farm Facts Notes + Quiz, Food and Facts presentation, The Future of Farming, Biggest Little Farm, Ag Literacy Poster

Name: _____

*Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:*

*stewardship* | *family farm* | *food dollar* | *export* | *biotechnology* | *precision ag* | *vertical farm* | *yield* | *myth*

## A. America's food producers

1. Each U.S. farmer feeds about _____ people.
2. About _____ % of U.S. farms are family-owned.
3. Farm families are about _____ % of the population.

## B. Food costs and exports

4. **The food dollar**

> Example: farmer's share is 16¢ of $1. On a $5 box of cereal: 5 × 16¢ = 80¢

a) Farmer's share of a $10 grocery bill = _____

b) Farmer's share of a $2 loaf of bread = _____

5. The top U.S. farm export is _____.
6. List 4 things from agriculture that are not food.

_____

## C. The future of farming

7. About _____ billion people may live on Earth by 2050.
8. How does precision ag help both farmers and the environment?

_____

_____

9. Write one myth about farming and the fact that busts it (for your poster).

_____

_____

# 🚜 U.S. Food & Farm Facts: Reading

Ag Science 1 · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with US Food and Farm Facts Notes + Quiz, Food and Facts presentation, The Future of Farming, Biggest Little Farm, Ag Literacy Poster

Name: _____

## Who Feeds America?

Farm and ranch families are only about 2% of the U.S. population, but each U.S. farmer feeds about 154 people. Together, U.S. farmers produce about 2.1 trillion pounds of food a year. About 97% of U.S. farms are owned by families, big and small.

Farmers grow more food using fewer resources than ever. Careful stewardship of soil and water helped cropland erosion drop nearly 50% since 1982. Americans spend the smallest share of their income on food of any country, about 10%, but of each dollar spent on food, the farmer gets only about 16 cents.

The United States sells farm products around the world. The top buyers are China, Canada and Mexico, and the top export is soybeans. The U.S. grows about a third of the world's corn and soybeans. Agriculture also gives us much more than food: lumber, medicine, latex gloves, shampoo, crayons, baseballs and fuel.

By 2050 there may be 9 to 10 billion people, so farmers must grow much more food. Biotechnology improves crops so they have higher yields and fewer pests and diseases. Precision agriculture uses GPS and auto-steer to raise yields, lower costs and use fewer chemicals. Vertical farms grow crops in stacked layers indoors.

For the Ag Literacy Poster, students teach one fact about agriculture and bust a common myth. Good posters check facts with trusted sources like the USDA or Washington Ag Statistics, and credit every source.

### Check your reading

1. About how many people does one U.S. farmer feed?

2. Of each $1 spent on food, how much does the farmer get?

3. Name one technology that will help feed 10 billion people.

# 🚜 U.S. Food & Farm Facts: Quick Check

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Name: _____

*Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.*

**1. About what share of U.S. farms are family-owned?**

A. 97% | B. 20% | C. 50%

**2. The top buyers of U.S. farm products are…**

A. France and Spain | B. Antarctica | C. China, Canada and Mexico

**3. Precision ag uses…**

A. Only horses | B. No machines | C. GPS and sensors

**4. A vertical farm grows crops…**

A. On mountains only | B. In stacked layers indoors | C. Underwater

5. Why must farmers grow more food in the future?

6. Why should you check facts for your Ag Literacy Poster?

# 🚜 U.S. Food & Farm Facts: Guided Notes · ANSWER KEY

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*stewardship* | *family farm* | *food dollar* | *export* | *biotechnology* | *precision ag* | *vertical farm* | *yield* | *myth*

## A. America's food producers

1. Each U.S. farmer feeds about **154** people.
2. About **97** % of U.S. farms are family-owned.
3. Farm families are about **2** % of the population.

## B. Food costs and exports

4. **The food dollar**

> Example: farmer's share is 16¢ of $1. On a $5 box of cereal: 5 × 16¢ = 80¢

a) Farmer's share of a $10 grocery bill = **$1.60**

b) Farmer's share of a $2 loaf of bread = **32¢**

5. The top U.S. farm export is **soybeans**.
6. List 4 things from agriculture that are not food.

**Any four: lumber, medicine, latex gloves, shampoo, lotion, crayons, paper, baseballs, fuel.**

## C. The future of farming

7. About **10** billion people may live on Earth by 2050.
8. How does precision ag help both farmers and the environment?

**GPS/auto-steer raise yield and lower costs, and farmers use fewer chemicals.**

9. Write one myth about farming and the fact that busts it (for your poster).

**Example: Myth: most farms are big companies. Fact: about 97% are family-owned.**

🔑 *Key written by our team from Mr. Torretta's materials, please check.*

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### Check your reading

1. About how many people does one U.S. farmer feed?
**About 154.**

2. Of each $1 spent on food, how much does the farmer get?
**About 16 cents.**

3. Name one technology that will help feed 10 billion people.
**Any: biotechnology, precision ag (GPS/auto-steer), vertical farms.**

# 🚜 U.S. Food & Farm Facts: Quick Check · ANSWER KEY

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**3. Precision ag uses…**

A. Only horses | B. No machines | **C. GPS and sensors**

**4. A vertical farm grows crops…**

A. On mountains only | **B. In stacked layers indoors** | C. Underwater

5. Why must farmers grow more food in the future?

**The population may reach 9-10 billion by 2050.**

6. Why should you check facts for your Ag Literacy Poster?

**To make sure the information is true; use trusted sources like the USDA and credit them.**

🔑 *Key written by our team from Mr. Torretta's quizzes and notes, please check.*